



STUDENT TEMPLATE

Project Proposal

Complete this proposal during and after Session 3. This is the foundation of your entire research project.

The Unicorn Labs Research Program



INSTRUCTIONS: Complete this proposal during and after Session 3. This is the foundation of your entire research project. Your mentor will review this and provide feedback at Session 4.

Student Name: _____

Mentor Name: _____

Date: _____

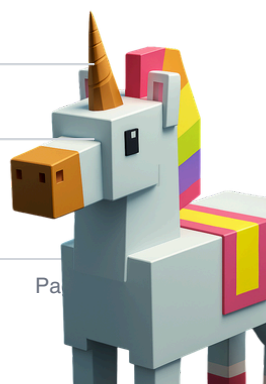
1. RESEARCH QUESTION

A strong research question is Specific, Answerable, Novel, and Significant (SANS). Write your finalized research question below.

My research question is:

2. WHY THIS MATTERS

In 3-5 sentences, explain why this research question is important. Who does this topic affect? Why should someone care about the answer? What real-world impact could your findings have?



3. WHAT WE ALREADY KNOW

In 3-5 sentences, summarize existing research. Reference 2-3 papers you've read. What do we know? What do we NOT know? Where is the gap?

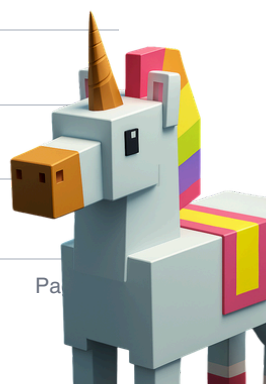
4. WHAT I PLAN TO DO (METHODOLOGY)

Research Method (check one):

- ☐ Survey / Questionnaire
- ☐ Data Analysis (existing dataset)
- ☐ Case Study
- ☐ Experiment
- ☐ Theoretical / Literature-Based Review
- ☐ Interviews
- ☐ Other: _____

My plan:

In 4-6 sentences, describe specifically what you will do.



5. WHAT I EXPECT TO FIND

In 2-3 sentences, describe your hypothesis or expected findings. It's okay if your actual findings turn out differently.

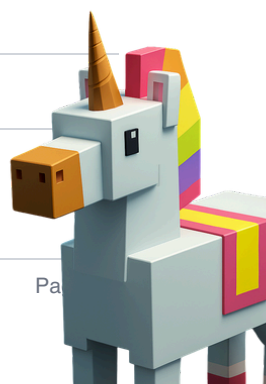
6. OUTPUT TRACK

Select the format for your final deliverable. Every track requires a written research paper (minimum 5 pages).

- ☐ Research Paper (Default) — 8-12 page academic paper
- ☐ Research Paper + App/Website — 5-page paper + functional prototype
- ☐ Research Paper + Podcast/Video — 5-page paper + 15-20 min episode
- ☐ Research Paper + Data Dashboard — 5-page paper + interactive visualization
- ☐ Research Paper + Policy Brief — 5-page paper + 2-page policy memo

Why I chose this track:

In 2-3 sentences, explain why this format best communicates your research.



7. TOOLS & RESOURCES I'LL NEED

List the specific tools, datasets, software, or resources you'll need.

1.

 2.

 3.

 4.

 5.

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8. POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

What obstacles do you anticipate? Identifying challenges early helps you plan around them.

1.

 2.

 3.

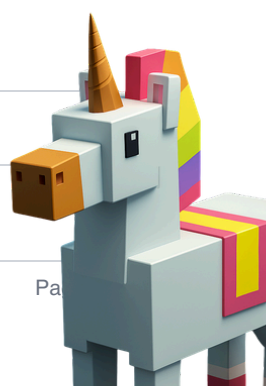
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SIGNATURES

By signing below, I confirm that I understand my research question, methodology, and output track, and I commit to completing this project with integrity and effort.

Student Name:

Student Signature:



Date: _____

Mentor Name: _____

Mentor Signature: _____

Date: _____

MENTOR NOTES (Internal Use)

Feasibility assessment: _____

Suggested adjustments: _____

Risk factors: _____

Approved: ☐ Yes ☐ Yes, with modifications ☐ Needs revision

